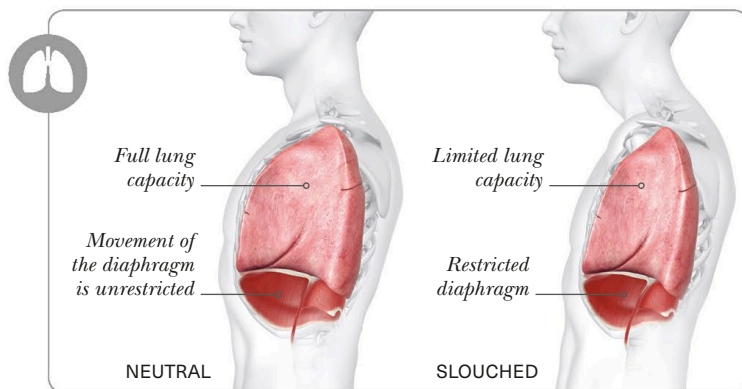


» CLOSER LOOK

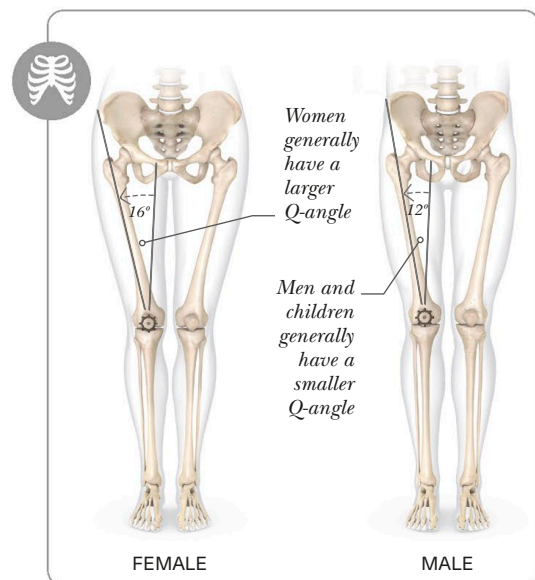
Mountain pose is an opportunity to find a stable, structurally sound base. The structure and placement of your feet can facilitate the foundation of that base.



Breathing and posture

When you slouch, you have limited lung capacity, as well as restricted movement of your diaphragm. From a yoga perspective, when you aren't breathing well, your prana, or vital energy, is not flowing properly. From

a physiological perspective, when your respiratory system is not efficient, neither are your cardiovascular, digestive, endocrine, or nervous systems. So, stand up tall and let your body function optimally.



Feet at hip distance

Some styles of yoga bring the feet together in Tadasana. However, while many modern asanas were developed for preadolescent boys in India, who have fairly narrow hips, yoga is now predominantly practiced by adult women, whose hips are wider. For many people, standing with the feet at hip distance is more stable, decreasing the Q-angle (shown left) and reducing stress on the knees.

LATERAL VIEW

